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Butterfly (*Lepidoptera*) diversity across four biogeographical regions of India: A systematic review

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Abstract

Background: Butterflies are important ecological indicators and play a vital role in ecosystem functioning through pollination and trophic interactions. Their diversity and distribution are influenced by habitat characteristics, vegetation type, and environmental conditions. Understanding regional patterns of butterfly diversity is therefore essential for biodiversity assessment and conservation planning.

Objective: The present study aims to compile and analyze published information on butterfly diversity from four major biogeographical regions of India-Deccan Peninsula, Western Ghats, East Coast, and West Coast-based on studies conducted during the last decade.

Results: the compiled dataset recorded a total of 429 butterfly species belonging to six families across the four regions. Among these, Nymphalidae was the most dominant family, followed by Lycaenidae, Hesperidae, Pieridae, Papilionidae, and Riodinidae.

Conclusion: This review provides a comprehensive overview of butterfly diversity across major biogeographical regions of India and emphasizes the importance of regional assessments for effective conservation and biodiversity management.

Keywords: Butterfly diversity, biogeographical regions, species richness, relative abundance, India

Introduction

Butterflies are an important component of natural ecosystems. They are widely recognized as effective bioindicators of environmental change (Malireddi *et al.*, 2025) [33]. Their presence and abundance often reflect ecosystem quality and stability. Butterflies also have aesthetic and economic value (Fitriani *et al.*, 2025) [18]. They enhance the natural beauty of landscapes. They support plant reproduction through pollination. In this way, they aid seed formation and help maintain plant diversity. Butterflies are conspicuous and attractive insects. They have bright colours, relatively large bodies and delicate wing patterns. These features have long attracted scientists and the general public. Their visibility and ease of observation make them suitable for studies on insect phenology, distribution and seasonal patterns (Bryant *et al.*, 2002) [5]. Among insects, butterflies are one of the most intensively studied groups. They play a key ecological role as pollinators (Ilyas *et al.*, 2025) [23]. They also act as energy carriers from herbivores to higher trophic levels in food chains. Many butterfly species are highly habitat specific and seasonal. They depend on particular host plants and specific environmental conditions for survival (Friberg *et al.*, 2008) [19]. As a result, their diversity and distribution are strongly influenced by geography, vegetation type and ecological requirements (Das *et al.*, 2025) [9, 12, 14, 15, 16]. Insects constitute more than half of the Earth's total biodiversity. Butterflies form an important group within this diversity. Globally, about 25,000 butterfly species have been recorded. Of these, approximately 1,501 species occur in India (Patil *et al.*, 2019) [40].

The present review synthesizes published information on butterfly diversity from four major geographical regions of India. These regions are the Deccan Plateau, the Eastern Coast, the Western Coast and the Western Ghats. The Western Ghats are a globally recognized biodiversity hotspot (Jose *et al.*, 2025) [25]. Many studies on butterfly diversity have been carried out in these regions. However, the available information is scattered in different publications. This review compiles research articles published during the last five years. It

assesses and compares butterfly diversity across these four regions.

The main objective of this study is to examine patterns of species richness and distribution among these regions. It aims to provide a comparative understanding of butterfly diversity. By integrating findings from multiple studies, this

review highlights regional variation in butterfly assemblages. It also contributes to a broader understanding of butterfly biodiversity in different ecological landscapes. This work represents one of the first comprehensive attempts to review and compare butterfly diversity across these four major geographical regions of India.

Materials and Methods

Study area

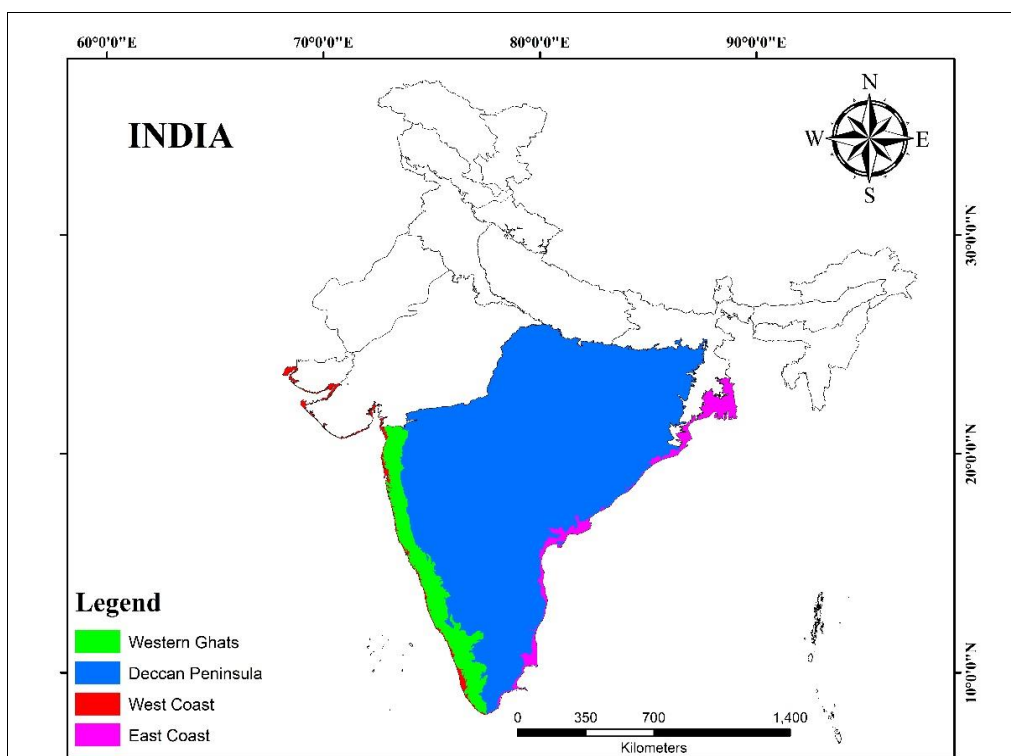


Fig 1: Map showing the four different geographical regions of India considered in the study

The selected studies were categorized according to four major biogeographical zones of India to facilitate regional comparison of butterfly diversity (Figure 1). These zones included the Deccan Plateau (covering inland regions of Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu), the Eastern Coast (including coastal areas of West Bengal, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu), the Western Coast (comprising coastal regions of Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, and Kerala), and the Western Ghats, which is globally recognized as a biodiversity hotspot extending through Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu. These regions encompass a wide range of ecological habitats such as tropical forests, moist deciduous forests, coastal ecosystems, grasslands, plantations, and urban green spaces that support diverse butterfly communities.

Literature search strategy

The present study was conducted using a systematic literature review approach to compile and analyse information on butterfly diversity reported from different biogeographical regions of India. Scientific publications published between 2020 and 2025 were collected from major academic databases, including Google Scholar, Scopus, Web of Science, ResearchGate, and various

institutional repositories. A structured search strategy was adopted using combinations of relevant keywords such as butterfly diversity, Lepidoptera, butterfly fauna, butterfly species checklist, butterfly survey, and butterfly diversity in India. Only peer-reviewed research articles, biodiversity survey reports, and faunal inventory studies that provided documented butterfly species lists were included in the review. Studies lacking clear species identification, methodological details, or complete data were excluded to ensure the reliability of the dataset. During the initial literature search, approximately 95 research papers were identified. After detailed screening based on relevance, availability of species records, and geographical coverage, 52 studies were selected for the final analysis. These studies included butterfly surveys conducted in protected areas, wildlife sanctuaries, forest reserves, agricultural landscapes, eco-tourism sites, and urban habitats. Each selected paper provided species lists along with information related to sampling methods, study location, and habitat characteristics. Relevant information from each selected publication was systematically extracted and organized in a spreadsheet database. The recorded parameters included study location, geographical coordinates (where available), biogeographical region, reported butterfly species, family classification, and habitat type. All reported species were

compiled to prepare a master checklist of butterfly species. Duplicate species records reported from multiple studies were carefully removed to avoid repetition.

Taxonomic verification

The scientific names and taxonomic classifications of all species were verified and updated using standard taxonomic references and the Butterflies of India database to ensure accuracy and consistency in nomenclature.

Data analysis

The compiled species data were subsequently organized according to their respective families, including Papilionidae, Pieridae, Nymphalidae, Lycaenidae, and

Hesperiidae. Species occurrences were grouped based on the four selected biogeographical zones to facilitate comparative analysis of regional diversity patterns. Species richness and family composition were analysed to evaluate the distribution and relative representation of butterfly families across different regions of India. The final dataset consisted of a consolidated checklist of butterfly species derived from the reviewed literature, which was used to assess regional diversity patterns and overall butterfly richness. The master species list generated through this systematic review provides a baseline reference for understanding butterfly diversity and distribution across major ecological regions of India and may support future biodiversity monitoring and conservation studies.

Results and Discussion

Table 1: List of butterfly species and their regional distribution across the deccan peninsula, western ghats, east coast and west coast

SL No.	Scientific name	Family	Common Names	Deccan Peninsula	Western Ghat	East Coast	West Coast	Distribution Type
1	Abaratha angulata	Hesperiidae	Oriental Chestnut Angle	P	P		P	Common
2	Abaratha ransonnettii	Hesperiidae	Dakhan Golden Angle	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
3	Abisara bifasciata	Riodinidae	Double Banded Judy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
4	Abisara echerius	Riodinidae	Plum Judy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
5	Acetolepis puspa	Lycaenidae	Common Hedge Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
6	Acraea issoria	Nymphalidae	Yellow Coster	P		P		Localized
7	Acraea terpsicore	Nymphalidae	Tawny Coster	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
8	Acraea violae	Nymphalidae	Tawny Coster	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
9	Aeromachus pygmaeus	Hesperiidae	Pygmy Scrub Hopper	P	P		P	Common
10	Aglais caschmirensis	Nymphalidae	Indian Tortoiseshell			P		Rare
11	Amblypodia anita	Lycaenidae	Leaf Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
12	Ampittia dioscorides	Hesperiidae	Common Bush Hopper	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
13	Anaphaeis aurota	Pieridae	Pioneer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
14	Ancema blanka	Pieridae	Silver Royal	P				Rare
15	Ancistroides curvifascia	Hesperiidae	Restricted Demon	P	P		P	Common
16	Ancistroides folus	Hesperiidae	Grass Demon	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
17	Ancistroides paralysos	Hesperiidae	Common Banded Demon	P	P		P	Common
18	Anthene emolus	Lycaenidae	Common ciliate blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
19	Anthene lycaenina	Lycaenidae	Pointed Ciliate Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
20	Anthocharis cardamines	Pieridae	Orange-tip	P				Rare
21	Appias albina	Pieridae	Common Albatross	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
22	Appias indra	Pieridae	Sahyadri Plain Puffin	P	P		P	Common
23	Appias lalage	Pieridae	Spot-puffin	P		P		Localized
24	Appias libythea	Pieridae	Striped Albatross	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
25	Appias lyncida	Pieridae	Chocolate Albatross	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
26	Appias olfena	Pieridae	Eastern striped albatross			P		Rare
27	Argynnis hyperbius	Nymphalidae	Indian Fritillary			P		Rare
28	Argynnis laodice	Nymphalidae	Pallas fritillary	P				Rare
29	Argynnis paphia	Nymphalidae	Silver-washed fritillary	P				Rare
30	Argyreus hyperbius	Nymphalidae	Indian Fritillary	P		P		Localized
31	Arhopala alea	Lycaenidae	Sahyadri Rosy Oakblue	P	P		P	Common
32	Arhopala amantes	Lycaenidae	Large Oakblue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
33	Arhopala atrax	Lycaenidae	Indian oakblue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
34	Arhopala bazalus	Lycaenidae	Teesta Powdered Oakblue			P		Rare
35	Arhopala centaurus	Papilionidae	Dull oak blue	P	P		P	Common
36	Arhopala nicevillei	Lycaenidae	large spotted oak blue	P				Rare
37	Arhopala oenea	Lycaenidae	Lackluster Oakblue			P		Rare
38	Ariadne ariadne	Nymphalidae	Angled Castor	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
39	Ariadne merione	Nymphalidae	Common Castor	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
40	Arnetta vindhiana	Hesperiidae	Vindhyan Bob	P	P		P	Common
41	Ascia monuste	Pieridae	Great Southern White	P				Rare
42	Asterocampa clyton	Nymphalidae	Tawny emperor	P				Rare
43	Athyma inara	Nymphalidae	Himalayan Colour Sergeant	P	P		P	Common

44	Athyma nefte	Nymphalidae	Colour Sergeant	P		P		Localized
45	Athyma nefte inara	Nymphalidae	Colour Sergeant	P		P		Localized
46	Athyma perius	Nymphalidae	Common Sergeant		P	P	P	Common
47	Athyma ranga	Nymphalidae	Karwar Blackvein Sergeant	P	P		P	Common
48	Athyma selenophora	Nymphalidae	Staff Sergeant	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
49	Atrophaneura aristolochiae	Papilionidae	Common Rose			P		Rare
50	Atrophaneura hector	Papilionidae	Crimson Rose	P	P	P		Common
51	Atrophaneura pandiyana	Papilionidae	Malabar Rose	P				Rare
52	Azonus jesous	Lycaenidae	African Babool Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
53	Azonus ubaldus	Lycaenidae	Bright Babool Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
54	Azonus uranus	Lycaenidae	Dull Babool Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
55	Badamia exclamationis	Hesperiidae	Brown Awl	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
56	Baoris farri	Hesperiidae	Paint-brush Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
57	Belenios aurota	Pieridae	Pioneer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
58	Bicyclus anynana	Nymphalidae	Squinting bush brown	P		P		Localized
59	Borbo bevani	Hesperiidae	Beaven's Swift	P				Rare
60	Borbo cinnara	Hesperiidae	Rice Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
61	Burara harisa	Hesperiidae	Orange Awlet	P		P		Localized
62	Burara jaina jaina	Hesperiidae	Orange-striped Awlet	P		P		Localized
63	Byblia ilithyia	Nymphalidae	The spotted joker	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
64	Caleta caleta	Lycaenidae	Angled Pierrot	P		P		Localized
65	Caleta decidia	Lycaenidae	Angled Pierrot	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
66	Caleta elna	Lycaenidae	Elbowed Pierrot			P		Rare
67	Caligo Martia	Nymphalidae	Owl butterflies	P				Rare
68	Callerebia narasingha	Nymphalidae	Mottled Argus			P		Rare
69	Callerebia nirmala	Nymphalidae	Common Argus			P		Rare
70	Caltoris canaraica	Hesperiidae	Karwar Swift	P	P		P	Common
71	Caltoris kumara	Hesperiidae	Sahyadri Blank Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
72	Caltoris philippina	Hesperiidae	Continental Philippine Swift	P	P		P	Common
73	Caprona agama	Hesperiidae	Spotted Angle	P		P		Localized
74	Castalius rosimon	Lycaenidae	Common Pierrot	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
75	Catapaecilma major	Lycaenidae	Sahyadri Common Tinsel	P	P		P	Common
76	Catochrysops panormus	Lycaenidae	Silver Forget -me- not	P		P		Localized
77	Catochrysops Strabo	Lycaenidae	Forgetmenot	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
78	Catopsilia pomona	Pieridae	Common Emigrant	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
79	Catopsilia crocale	Pieridae	Common Emigrant	P	P		P	Common
80	Catopsilia Florella	Pieridae	African migrant	P	P	P		Common
81	Catopsilia pyracantha	Pieridae	Mottled Emigrant	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
82	Catopsilia pyranthe	Pieridae	Mottled emigrant	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
83	Catopsilia scylla	Pieridae	Orange Emigrant	P		P		Localized
84	Celaenorrhinus leucocera	Hesperiidae	Common Spotted Flat			P		Rare
85	Celastrina lavendularis	Lycaenidae	Plain hedge blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
86	Celatoxia albidisca	Lycaenidae	White-disc Hedge Blue	P		P		Localized
87	Cephrenes acalle	Hesperiidae	Variable Plain Palm-Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
88	Cepora nadina	Pieridae	Lesser Gull	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
89	Cepora nerissa	Pieridae	Common gull	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
90	Cethosia cyane	Nymphalidae	Leopard Lacewing			P		Rare
91	Charaxes agrarius	Nymphalidae	Anomalous Nawab	P	P		P	Common
92	Charaxes athamas	Nymphalidae	Common Nawab	P	P	P		Common
93	Charaxes bernardus	Nymphalidae	Tawny Rajah	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
94	Charaxes bhārata	Nymphalidae	Indian Nawab	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
95	Charaxes polyxena	Nymphalidae	Tawny Rajah	P		P		Localized
96	Charaxes psaphon	Nymphalidae	Indian Plain Tawny Rajah	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
97	Charaxes solon	Nymphalidae	Black Rajah	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
98	Cheritra freja	Lycaenidae	Common Imperial			P		Rare
99	Chersonesia risa	Nymphalidae	Common Maplet	P		P		Localized
100	Chilades pandava	Lycaenidae	Plains Cupid	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
101	Chilades lajus	Lycaenidae	Lime Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
102	Chilades parrhasius	Lycaenidae	Small Cupid	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
103	Chilades trochylus	Lycaenidae	Grass Jewel	P	P	P		Common
104	Chilasa clytia	Papilionidae	Common Mime	P		P		Localized
105	Chliaria othona	Lycaenidae	Orchid Tit	P		P		Localized
106	Cigaritis acamas	Lycaenidae	Tawny Silver Line	P	P	P		Common
107	Cigaritis lohita	Lycaenidae	Tamil Long-banded Silverline	P	P		P	Common
108	Cigaritis schistacea	Lycaenidae	Plumbeous Silverline	P	P		P	Common
109	Cigaritis vulcanus	Lycaenidae	Common Silverline	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
110	Cirrochroa aoris	Nymphalidae	Large Yeoman			P		Rare
111	Cirrochroa thais	Nymphalidae	Tamil Yeoman	P	P		P	Common

112	<i>Cogia hippalus</i>	Hesperiidae	Acacia Skipper	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
113	<i>Coladenia indrani</i>	Hesperiidae	Tricolour Pied Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
114	<i>Colias fieldii</i>	Pieridae	Dark clouded grass yellow	P		P		Localized
115	<i>Colias hyale</i>	Pieridae	Pale Clouded Yellow	P				Rare
116	<i>Colotis amata</i>	Pieridae	Small salmon Arab	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
117	<i>Colotis aurora</i>	Pieridae	Sulphur orange tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
118	<i>Colotis danae</i>	Pieridae	Crimson tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
119	<i>Colotis etrida</i>	Pieridae	Small Orange Tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
120	<i>Colotis evagore</i>	Pieridae	Desert Orange Tip	P	P	P		Common
121	<i>Colotis fausta</i>	Pieridae	Large Salmon Arab	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
122	<i>Colotis phisadia</i>	Pieridae	White Arab		P		P	Localized
123	<i>Creon cleobis</i>	Lycaenidae	Bengal Broad-tail Roya	P	P		P	Common
124	<i>Cupha erymanthis</i>	Nymphalidae	Rustic	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
125	<i>Cupido lacturnus</i>	Lycaenidae	Indian cupid	P	P		P	Common
126	<i>Cupitha purreea</i>	Hesperiidae	Wax Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
127	<i>Curetis acuta</i>	Lycaenidae	Angled Sunbeam	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
128	<i>Curetis thetis</i>	Lycaenidae	Indian Sunbeam	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
129	<i>Cynitia lepidea</i>	Nymphalidae	Grey Count	P		P		Localized
130	<i>Cyrestis cocles</i>	Nymphalidae	Marbled map	P		P		Localized
131	<i>Cyrestis thyodamas</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Map	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
132	<i>Danaus chrysippus</i>	Nymphalidae	Plain Tiger	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
133	<i>Danaus genutia</i>	Nymphalidae	Striped Tiger	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
134	<i>Danaus plexippus</i>	Nymphalidae	Monarch butterfly	P	P		P	Common
135	<i>Delias descombesi</i>	Pieridae	Red-Spot Jezebel	P	P	P		Common
136	<i>Delias eucharis</i>	Pieridae	Common Jezebel	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
137	<i>Delias hyparete</i>	Pieridae	Painted Jezebel	P				Rare
138	<i>Delias pasithoe</i>	Pieridae	Red-base Jezebel			P		Rare
139	<i>Deudorix epijarbas</i>	Lycaenidae	Cornelian	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
140	<i>Deudorix isocrates</i>	Lycaenidae	Common Guava Blue			P		Rare
141	<i>Discolampa ethion</i>	Lycaenidae	Banded Blue Pierrot	P	P		P	Common
142	<i>Discophora lepida</i>	Lycaenidae	Sahyadri Duffer	P	P		P	Common
143	<i>Dismorphinae</i>	Pieridae	Common vagrant	P				Rare
144	<i>Dodona dipoea</i>	Riodinidae	Lesser Punch			P		Rare
145	<i>Dodona egeon</i>	Riodinidae	Orange Punch	P				Rare
146	<i>Doleschallia bisaltide</i>	Nymphalidae	Autumn leaf	P				Rare
147	<i>Dophla evelina</i>	Nymphalidae	Sahyadri Redspot Duke	P	P		P	Common
148	<i>Elymnias caudata</i>	Nymphalidae	Tailed palmfly	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
149	<i>Elymnias hypermnestra</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Palmfly	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
150	<i>Enispe cynus</i>	Nymphalidae	Blue Caliph	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
151	<i>Erionota thrax</i>	Hesperiidae	Banana Skipper.	P	P		P	Common
152	<i>Erionota torus</i>	Hesperiidae	Rounded palm redeye	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
153	<i>Euchrysops cnejus</i>	Lycaenidae	The gram blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
154	<i>Euchrysops malathana</i>	Lycaenidae	Common Smoky Blue	P	P	P		Common
155	<i>Euchrysops pandava</i>	Lycaenidae	Plains Cupid	P		P		Localized
156	<i>Euploea core</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Crow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
157	<i>Euploea core core</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Crow	P	P		P	Common
158	<i>Euploea eunice</i>	Nymphalidae	Blue-banded King Crow	P		P		Localized
159	<i>Euploea klugii</i>	Nymphalidae	Brown King Crow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
160	<i>Euploea klugii kollari</i>	Nymphalidae	Brown King Crow	P		P		Localized
161	<i>Euploea midamus</i>	Nymphalidae	Blue Spotted Crow			P		Rare
162	<i>Euploea mulciber</i>	Nymphalidae	Blue Crow			P		Rare
163	<i>Euploea Sylvester</i>	Nymphalidae	Double Branded crow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
164	<i>Euploeini core</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Indian Crow	P		P		Localized
165	<i>Eurema andersoni</i>	Pieridae	One Spot Grass Yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
166	<i>Eurema andersonii</i>	Pieridae	One-spot Grass yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
167	<i>Eurema blanda</i>	Pieridae	Three-spot Grass Yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
168	<i>Eurema brigitta</i>	Pieridae	Small Grass Yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
169	<i>Eurema drona</i>	Pieridae	Red-line Small Grass Yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
170	<i>Eurema hecabe</i>	Pieridae	Common Grass Yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
171	<i>Eurema laeta</i>	Pieridae	Spotless Grass Yellow	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
172	<i>Eurema Mexicana</i>	Pieridae	Mexican yellow	P				Rare
173	<i>Euripus consimilis</i>	Pieridae	Painted courtesan	P		P		Localized
174	<i>Euthalia acanthea</i>	Nymphalidae	The common baron	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
175	<i>Euthalia lubentina</i>	Nymphalidae	Gaudy Baron	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
176	<i>Euthalia monina</i>	Nymphalidae	Powdered Baron	P		P		Localized
177	<i>Euthalia nais</i>	Nymphalidae	Baronet	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
178	<i>Everes lacturnus</i>	Lycaenidae	Indian Cupid	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
179	<i>Freyeria putli</i>	Lycaenidae	Black-Spotted Grass Jewel	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous

180	Freyeria trochylus	Lycaenidae	Grass jewel	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
181	G. doson	Papilionidae	Common Jay	P		P		Localized
182	Gandaca harina	Pieridae	Common Grass Yellow	P		P		Localized
183	Gangara thyrasis	Hesperiidae	Giant Redeye	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
184	Gerosis bhagava	Hesperiidae	Common yellow-breastedflat	P	P		P	Common
185	Gomalia elma	Hesperiidae	African Marbled Skipper	P	P	P		Common
186	Graphium agamemnon	Papilionidae	Tailed Jay	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
187	Graphium antiphates	Papilionidae	Fivebar Swordtail	P		P		Localized
188	Graphium doson	Papilionidae	Common Jay	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
189	Graphium macareus	Papilionidae	Lesser Zebra	P		P		Localized
190	Graphium nomius	Papilionidae	Spot Swordtail	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
191	Graphium sarpedon	Papilionidae	Common Bluebottle	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
192	Graphium teredon	Papilionidae	Southern Bluebottle	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
193	Halpe hindu	Hesperiidae	Sahyadri Banded Ace	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
194	Halpe porus	Hesperiidae	Moore's Ace	P	P		P	Common
195	Hasora badra	Hesperiidae	Common Awl	P		P		Localized
196	Hasora chormus	Hesperiidae	Common Banded Awl	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
197	Hasora taminatus	Hesperiidae	White Banded Awl	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
198	Hasora vitta	Hesperiidae	Plain Banded Awl	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
199	Hebomoia glaucippe	Pieridae	Great Orange Tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
200	Heliophorus epicles	Lycaenidae	Purple Sapphire	P		P		Localized
201	Hemiargus ceraunus	Lycaenidae	The ceraunus blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
202	Hemiargus ramon	Lycaenidae	Ramon's Blue		P		P	Localized
203	Heptis soma	Papilionidae	The Crimpson Rose	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
204	Horaga onyx	Lycaenidae	Common Onyx	P	P		P	Common
205	Hyarotis adrastus	Hesperiidae	tree flitter	P	P	P		Common
206	Hypolimnas alimena	Nymphalidae	Blue-banded eggfly	P		P		Localized
207	Hypolimnas bolima	Nymphalidae	The Great egg fly	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
208	Hypolimnas misippus	Nymphalidae	Danaid Eggfly	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
209	Hypolycaena othona	Lycaenidae	Orchid Tit	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
210	Iambrix salsala	Hesperiidae	Chestnut Bob	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
211	Iambrix salsala luteipalpis	Hesperiidae	Southern Chestnut Bob	P	P		P	Common
212	Idea malabarica	Nymphalidae	Malabar tree nymph		P		P	Localized
213	Iraota timoleon	Lycaenidae	Silverstreak Blue	P	P	P		Common
214	Ixias marianne	Pieridae	White Orange Tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
215	Ixias pyrene	Pieridae	Yellow Orange-Tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
216	Jamides alecto	Lycaenidae	Metallic cerulean	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
217	Jamides bochus	Lycaenidae	Dark Cerulean	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
218	Jamides celeno	Lycaenidae	Common Cerulean	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
219	Junonia almana	Nymphalidae	Peacock Pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
220	Junonia atlites	Nymphalidae	Grey Pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
221	Junonia coenia	Nymphalidae	Common buckeye	P		P		Localized
222	Junonia hedonia	Nymphalidae	The brown pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
223	Junonia hierta	Nymphalidae	Yellow Pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
224	Junonia iphita	Nymphalidae	Chocolate Pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
225	Junonia iphita iphita	Nymphalidae	Oriental Chocolate Pansy			P		Rare
226	Junonia ipthia	Nymphalidae	Chocolate Pansy	P		P		Localized
227	Junonia lemonias	Nymphalidae	Lemon Pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
228	Junonia oenone	Nymphalidae	Dark Blue Pansy	P	P		P	Common
229	Junonia orithya	Nymphalidae	Blue Pansy	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
230	Kallima orisfieldii	Nymphalidae	Sahyadri Blue Oakleaf	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
231	Kallima inachus	Nymphalidae	Orange Oakleaf			P		Rare
232	Kaniska canace	Nymphalidae	Blue Admiral	P	P		P	Common
233	Kricogonia lyside	Pieridae	The lyside sulphur	P		P		Localized
234	Lampides boeticus	Lycaenidae	Pea Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
235	Lasippa viraja	Nymphalidae	Yellowjack Sailer	P				Rare
236	Leptosia nina	Pieridae	Psyche	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
237	Leptotes cassius	Lycaenidae	Cassius blue or tropical striped blue	P		P		Localized
238	Leptotes plinius	Lycaenidae	Zebra Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
239	Lethe confusa	Nymphalidae	Banded Treebrown	P		P		Localized
240	Lethe drypetis	Nymphalidae	Tamil Treebrown	P	P		P	Common
241	Lethe europa	Nymphalidae	Bamboo Treebrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
242	Lethe rohria	Nymphalidae	Common Treebrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
243	Libythea laius	Nymphalidae	Southern Beak	P	P	P		Common
244	Libythea lepita	Nymphalidae	Common Beak	P		P		Localized
245	Libythea myrrha	Nymphalidae	Sri Lankan Club Beak	P	P		P	Common
246	Libythea myrrha rama	Nymphalidae	Club Beak	P		P		Localized
247	Local melanippus	Nymphalidae	White Tiger	P				Rare

248	<i>Loxura atymnus</i>	Lycaenidae	Yamfly	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
249	<i>Luthrodes pandava</i>	Lycaenidae	Plains Cupid	P	P		P	Common
250	<i>Lxias marianne</i>	Pieridae	White Orange Tip	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
251	<i>Lxias pyrene</i>	Pieridae	Yellow orange tip	P	P	P		Common
252	<i>Mahathala ameria</i>	Lycaenidae	falcate oakblue	P		P		Localized
253	<i>Matapa aria</i>	Hesperiidae	Common Redeye	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
254	<i>Megisba malaya</i>	Lycaenidae	Malayan Pied Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
255	<i>Melanitis leda</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Evening Brown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
256	<i>Melanitis phedima</i>	Nymphalidae	Dark Evening Brown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
257	<i>Melanitis zitenius</i>	Nymphalidae	Great Evening Brown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
258	<i>Moduza procris</i>	Nymphalidae	Commander	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
259	<i>Morpho menelaus</i>	Nymphalidae	Menelaus Blue Morpho	P		P		Localized
260	<i>Morpho peleides</i>	Nymphalidae	Peleides blue morpho	P				Rare
261	<i>Mycalesis anaxias</i>	Nymphalidae	White-bar Bushbrown	P		P		Localized
262	<i>Mycalesis junonia</i>	Nymphalidae	Malabar Glad-eye Bushbrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
263	<i>Mycalesis mineus</i>	Nymphalidae	Dark brand Bush brown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
264	<i>Mycalesis orcha</i>	Nymphalidae	Pale-brand Bushbrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
265	<i>Mycalesis patnia</i>	Nymphalidae	Glad - eye Bushbrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
266	<i>Mycalesis perseus</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Bushbrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
267	<i>Mycalesis subdita</i>	Nymphalidae	Tamil Bushbrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
268	<i>Mycalesis visala</i>	Nymphalidae	Long-brand Bushbrown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
269	<i>Nacaduba beroe</i>	Lycaenidae	Opaque Six-line Blue	P	P		P	Common
270	<i>Nacaduba kurava</i>	Lycaenidae	Transparent Six-Lineblue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
271	<i>Neopithecops zalmora</i>	Lycaenidae	Quaker	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
272	<i>Neptis ananta</i>	Nymphalidae	Yellow Sailer	P		P		Localized
273	<i>Neptis clinia</i>	Nymphalidae	Clear Sailer	P				Rare
274	<i>Neptis hylas</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Sailor	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
275	<i>Neptis jumbah</i>	Nymphalidae	Chestnut - streaked Sailer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
276	<i>Neptis mahendra</i>	Nymphalidae	Himalayan Sailer	P		P		Localized
277	<i>Neptis nata</i>	Nymphalidae	Clear Sailer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
278	<i>Neptis sankara</i>	Nymphalidae	Broad-banded Sailer	P		P		Localized
279	<i>Notocrypta curvifascia</i>	Hesperiidae	Restricted Demon	P		P		Localized
280	<i>Notocrypta paralysos</i>	Hesperiidae	Common Banded Demon	P				Rare
281	<i>Odontoptilum angulata</i>	Hesperiidae	Chestnut Angle	P		P		Localized
282	<i>Oriens concinna</i>	Hesperiidae	Sahyadri Dartlet	P	P		P	Common
283	<i>Oriens gola</i>	Hesperiidae	Oriental Common Dartlet	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
284	<i>Oriens goloides</i>	Hesperiidae	Indian Dartlet	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
285	<i>Orsotriaena medus</i>	Nymphalidae	Medus Brown	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
286	<i>Pachliopta aristolochiae</i>	Papilionidae	Common Rose	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
287	<i>Pachliopta hector</i>	Papilionidae	Crimson Rose	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
288	<i>Pachliopta pandiyana</i>	Papilionidae	Malabar Rose	P	P		P	Common
289	<i>Palantha alcippe</i>	Nymphalidae	Small Leopard	P		P		Localized
290	<i>Pantoporia hordonia</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Lascar	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
291	<i>Pantoporia perius</i>	Nymphalidae	Common Sergeant	P	P		P	Common
292	<i>Pantoporia sandaka</i>	Nymphalidae	Extra Lascar			P		Rare
293	<i>Papilio agenor</i>	Papilionidae	Great Mormon	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
294	<i>Papilio bianor</i>	Papilionidae	Common Peacock	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
295	<i>Papilio buddha</i>	Papilionidae	Malabar Banded Peacock	P	P		P	Common
296	<i>Papilio clytia</i>	Papilionidae	Common Mime	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
297	<i>Papilio crino</i>	Papilionidae	Common Banded Peacock	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
298	<i>Papilio daksha</i>	Papilionidae	Large-spotted Helen	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
299	<i>Papilio demodocus</i>	Papilionidae	Citrus swallowtail	P				Rare
300	<i>Papilio demoleus</i>	Papilionidae	Common Lime	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
301	<i>Papilio dravidarum</i>	Papilionidae	Malabar raven	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
302	<i>Papilio helenus</i>	Papilionidae	Red Helen	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
303	<i>Papilio liomedon</i>	Papilionidae	Malabar Banded Swallowtail	P		P		Localized
304	<i>Papilio nephelus</i>	Papilionidae	Yellow Helen			P		Rare
305	<i>Papilio nireus</i>	Papilionidae	African blue banded swallowtail	P		P		Localized
306	<i>Papilio nomius</i>	Papilionidae	Spot Swordtail	P				Rare
307	<i>Papilio paris</i>	Papilionidae	Paris Peacock	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
308	<i>Papilio polymnestor</i>	Papilionidae	Blue Mormon	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
309	<i>Papilio polytes</i>	Papilionidae	Common Mormon	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
310	<i>Papilio polyxenes</i>	Papilionidae	American swallowtail	P				Rare
311	<i>Papilio xuthus</i>	Papilionidae	Asian Swallowtail	P		P		Localized
312	<i>Parantica aglea</i>	Nymphalidae	Glassy Tiger	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
313	<i>Pararge aegeria</i>	Nymphalidae	Speckled wood	P	P		P	Common
314	<i>Pareronia hippia</i>	Pieridae	Indian Wanderer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
315	<i>Pareronia perius</i>	Pieridae	Common Wanderer	P		P		Localized

316	Pareronia valeria	Pieridae	Common Wanderer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
317	Parnara bada	Hesperiidae	Oriental Straight Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
318	Parnara ganga	Hesperiidae	Continental Swift	P	P		P	Common
319	Parnara guttata	Hesperiidae	Straight swift	P				Rare
320	Parnara guttatus	Hesperiidae	Straight swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
321	Parthenos sylvia	Nymphalidae	Blue Clipper	P	P	P		Common
322	Pelopidas agna	Hesperiidae	Dark branded swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
323	Pelopidas conjuncta	Hesperiidae	Sahyadri Conjoined Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
324	Pelopidas mathias	Hesperiidae	Small Branded Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
325	Pelopidas sinensis	Hesperiidae	Large Branded Swift	P		P		Localized
326	Pelopidas subochracea	Hesperiidae	Large Branded Swift	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
327	Petrelaea dana	Lycaenidae	Dingy Line Blue	P	P		P	Common
328	Phaedyra columella	Nymphalidae	Short Banded Sailer	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
329	Phalanta alcippe	Nymphalidae	Small leopard	P				Rare
330	Phalanta phalantha	Nymphalidae	Common Leopard	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
331	Pieris brassicae	Pieridae	Large Cabbage White	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
332	Pieris canidia	Pieridae	Indian Cabbage White	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
333	Pieris erutae	Pieridae	Green-veined White		P		P	Localized
334	Pieris rapae	Pieridae	Cabbage Butterfly	P		P		Localized
335	Polytremis lubricans	Hesperiidae	Oriental Contiguous Swift	P	P		P	Common
336	Polyura agraius	Nymphalidae	Anomalous Nawab	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
337	Polyura athamas	Nymphalidae	Common Nawab	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
338	Polyura schreiber	Nymphalidae	Blue Nawab	P				Rare
339	Potanthus confucius	Hesperiidae	Chinese Dart	P		P		Localized
340	Potanthus diana	Hesperiidae	Chinese Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
341	Potanthus palnia	Hesperiidae	Palni Dart	P	P		P	Common
342	Potanthus pava	Hesperiidae	Pava Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
343	Potanthus pseudomaesa	Hesperiidae	Common Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
344	Pratapa deva	Lycaenidae	White Tufted Royal	P		P		Localized
345	Precis lemonias	Nymphalidae	Lemon Pansy	P		P		Localized
346	Prioneris sita	Pieridae	Painted Sawtooth	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
347	Prosotas dubiosa	Lycaenidae	Tailless Lineblue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
348	Prosotas nora	Lycaenidae	Common Lineblue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
349	Prosotas noreia	Lycaenidae	White-tipped Lineblue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
350	Pseudoborbo bevani	Hesperiidae	Bevan's Swift	P	P		P	Common
351	Pseudocoladenia dan	Hesperiidae	Fulvous Pied Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
352	Pseudozizeeria maha	Lycaenidae	Pale Grass Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
353	Pyrgus malvae	Hesperiidae	Grizzled Skipper	P	P	P		Common
354	Pyrisitia nise	Pieridae	Mimosa yellow	P		P		Localized
355	Rachana jalindra	Lycaenidae	Banded Royal	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
356	Rapala arbustus	Lycaenidae	common red flash	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
357	Rapala manea	Lycaenidae	Slate Flash	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
358	Rapala pheretima	Lycaenidae	Copper Flash	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
359	Rapala varuna	Lycaenidae	indigo flash	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
360	Rathinda amor	Lycaenidae	Monkey Puzzle	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
361	Rolf Nussbaumer	Nymphalidae	Black swallow tail	P		P		Localized
362	Rohana parisatis	Nymphalidae	Black Prince			P		Rare
363	Sarangesa dasahara	Hesperiidae	Common Small Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
364	Sarangesa purendra	Hesperiidae	Spotted Small Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
365	Spalgis epus	Lycaenidae	Apefly	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
366	Spialia galba	Hesperiidae	Indian Skipper	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
367	Spindasis elima	Lycaenidae	Scarce Shot Silverline		P		P	Localized
368	Spindasis ictis	Lycaenidae	Common Shot Silverline	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
369	Spindasis lohita	Lycaenidae	Long - banded Silverline	P		P		Localized
370	Spindasis schistacea	Lycaenidae	Plumbeous silverline	P		P		Localized
371	Spindasis syama	Lycaenidae	Club Silverline	P		P		Localized
372	Spindasis vulcanus	Lycaenidae	Common Silverline	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
373	Stallingsia maculosus	Hesperiidae	Manfreda Giant Skipper	P	P	P		Common
374	Stibochiona nicea	Nymphalidae	Popinjay	P		P		Localized
375	Suastus gremius	Hesperiidae	Indian Palm Bob	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
376	Surendra quercetorum	Lycaenidae	Common Acacia Blue	P		P		Localized
377	Symbrenthia hypselis	Nymphalidae	Himalayan Jester	P		P		Localized
378	Symbrenthia lilaea	Nymphalidae	Common Jester	P		P		Localized
379	Symphaedra nais	Nymphalidae	Baronet	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
380	Tagiades gana	Hesperiidae	Suffused Snow Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
381	Tagiades japetus	Hesperiidae	Common Snow Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
382	Tagiades litigiosa	Hesperiidae	Water Snow Flat	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
383	Tagiades obscurus	Hesperiidae	Sylhet Water Snow Flat	P	P		P	Common

384	Tagiades silvia	Hesperiidae	Dakhan Suffused Snow Flat	P	P		P	Common
385	Tajuria cippus	Papilionidae	Peacock royal	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
386	Talica nyseus	Lycaenidae	Red Pierrot	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
387	Tanaecia julii	Nymphalidae	Common Earl	P		P		Localized
388	Tanaecia lepidea	Nymphalidae	Grey Count	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
389	Taractrocera ceramas	Hesperiidae	Tamil Grass Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
390	Taractrocera maevius	Hesperiidae	Common grass dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
391	Taraka hamada	Lycaenidae	Forest Pierrot	P	P	P		Common
392	Tarucus ananda	Lycaenidae	Dark Pierrot	P	P		P	Common
393	Tarucus balkanica	Pieridae	balkan pierrot	P				Rare
394	Tarucus balkanicus	Lycaenidae	Black-spotted Pierrot	P	P	P		Common
395	Tarucus callinara	Lycaenidae	spotted pierrot	P		P		Localized
396	Tarucus extricatus	Lycaenidae	Rounded Pierrot	P	P		P	Common
397	Tarucus indica	Lycaenidae	Pointed Pierrot	P	P		P	Common
398	Tarucus nara	Lycaenidae	Rounded Pierrot	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
399	Telicota ancilla	Hesperiidae	Dark Palm Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
400	Telicota bambusae	Hesperiidae	Dark Palm-Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
401	Telicota colon	Hesperiidae	Pale Palm Dart	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
402	Thaduka multicaudata	Lycaenidae	Karwar Many-tailed Oakblue	P	P		P	Common
403	Tirumala limniace	Nymphalidae	Blue Tiger	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
404	Tirumala septentrionis	Nymphalidae	Dark blue tiger	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
405	Troides helena	Papilionidae	Common Birdwing	P		P		Localized
406	Troides minos	Papilionidae	Southern Bird Wing	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
407	Udara akasa	Lycaenidae	Sahyadri White Hedge Blue	P	P		P	Common
408	Udaspes folus	Hesperiidae	Grass Demon	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
409	Vagrans sinha	Nymphalidae	Vagrant	P				Rare
410	Vanessa cardui	Nymphalidae	Painted Lady	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
411	Vanessa indica	Nymphalidae	Indian Red Admiral	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
412	Vindula erota	Nymphalidae	Cruiser	P	P	P		Common
413	Virachola isocrates	Lycaenidae	Guava Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
414	Virachola perse	Lycaenidae	Tamil Large Guava Blue		P		P	Localized
415	Ypthima asterope	Nymphalidae	Common three-ring	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
416	Ypthima baldus	Nymphalidae	Common Fivering	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
417	Ypthima ceylonica	Nymphalidae	White Four-ring	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
418	Ypthima huebneri	Nymphalidae	Common Fourring	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
419	Ypthima nareda	Nymphalidae	Large Three Ring	P	P		P	Common
420	Ypthima nikaea	Nymphalidae	Moore's Fivering	P		P		Localized
421	Ypthima striata	Nymphalidae	Striated Five-ring	P	P		P	Common
422	Zeltus amasa	Riodinidae	Fluffy Tit	P		P		Localized
423	Zemerus flegyas	Riodinidae	Punchinello			P		Rare
424	Zesius chrysomallus	Lycaenidae	Redspot	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
425	Zizeeria karsandra	Lycaenidae	Dark Grass Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
426	Zizeeria trochilus	Lycaenidae	Grass Jewel	P		P		Localized
427	Zizina labradus	Lycaenidae	Common Grass Blue			P		Rare
428	Zizina otis	Lycaenidae	Lesser Grass Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous
429	Zizula hylax	Lycaenidae	Tiny Grass Blue	P	P	P	P	Ubiquitous

P P P P	Ubiquitous/Widespread /Dominant
P P P	Common/Abundant
P P	Localized/Frequent/ Less Common
P	Rare/Uncommon/ Sparse

The available literature indicates that butterfly diversity has been extensively documented across different regions, with several studies reporting family-wise occurrences and ecological patterns. Among the recorded families, Nymphalidae represents the most frequently reported group, with records from numerous studies including Palei *et al.* (2014) [38], Gaude *et al.* (2015) [20], Suryanarayan *et al.* (2018), Nandana *et al.* (2019), Hedge *et al.* (2020), Virani *et al.* (2025) and Das *et al.* (2026) [10]. The dominance of this family in various surveys highlights its broad ecological adaptability and wide habitat tolerance. Similarly, members of the Lycaenidae have been widely documented in the literature, with contributions from Palei *et al.* (2014) [38], Suryanarayan *et al.* (2018), Virani *et al.*

al. (2020) [56], Nagarjan *et al.* (2020), Bhowate *et al.* (2020) [4], Harisha *et al.* (2021) [21], Mahata *et al.* (2022), Vanaja *et al.* (2023) [55], Rout *et al.* (2023) [42, 43], Kokkadan *et al.* (2023), Karan *et al.* (2023) [26], Das *et al.* (2023) [13], Saha *et al.* (2023) [44], Sharma (2024) [46], Mori *et al.* (2024) [35], Thilak *et al.* (2024) [51], Malek *et al.* (2024) [32], Pandram *et al.* (2024) [39], Uratwad *et al.* (2024) [54], Santosh *et al.* (2025), Konakondla *et al.* (2025) [27], Sreebha (2025) [48], (2020) [56], Nagarjan *et al.* (2020), Bhowate *et al.* (2020) [4], Ashwin *et al.* (2021), Virani *et al.* (2022) [57], Mahata *et al.* (2022), Trivedi *et al.* (2022) [53], Rout *et al.* (2023) [42, 43], Thirupamreddy *et al.* (2023) [52], Vanaja *et al.* (2023) [55], Saha *et al.* (2023) [44], Narmadha *et al.* (2023) [37], Karan *et al.* (2023) [26], Jaiswal *et al.* (2023) [24], Mallicka

et al. (2023) ^[34], Das et al. (2023) ^[13], Mori et al. (2024) ^[35], Thilak et al. (2024) ^[51], Malek et al. (2024) ^[32], Kumari et al. (2025) and Das et al. (2026) ^[10]. These studies suggest that Lycaenidae species often exhibit strong associations with specific host plants and microhabitats, contributing significantly to local butterfly assemblages.

The family Pieridae has also been frequently recorded across multiple ecological surveys. Important contributions include Palei et al. (2014) ^[38], Gaude et al. (2015) ^[20], Suryanarayan et al. (2018), Dabhadkar et al. (2020) ^[8], Virani et al. (2020) ^[56], Hedge et al. (2020), Harisha et al. (2021) ^[21], Mallicka et al. (2023) ^[34], Das et al. (2023) ^[13], Vanaja et al. (2023) ^[55], Narmadha et al. (2023) ^[37], Saha et al. (2023) ^[44], Jaiswal et al. (2023) ^[24], Rout et al. (2023) ^[42, 43], Pandram et al. (2024) ^[39], Mori et al. (2024) ^[35], Tandan et al. (2024) ^[50], Sharma (2024) ^[46], Santosh et al. (2025), Anbalagan et al. (2025) ^[2], Kumari et al. (2025) and Das et al. (2026) ^[10], highlighting their widespread distribution and adaptability to both natural and modified habitats.

Butterflies belonging to the Papilionidae have been documented in several regional studies including Palei et al. (2014) ^[38], Suryanarayan et al. (2018), Nandana et al. (2019), Nagarjan et al. (2020), Hedge et al. (2020), Bhowate et al. (2020) ^[4], Harisha et al. (2021) ^[21], Kokkadan et al. (2023), Das et al. (2023) ^[13], Vanaja et al. (2023) ^[55], Sharma (2024) ^[46], Das et al. (2024) ^[11], Thilak et al. (2024) ^[51], Santosh et al. (2025), Kumari et al. (2025) and Das et al. (2026) ^[10]. Although comparatively fewer in number than other families, Papilionidae species are often considered ecologically significant indicators of habitat quality.

Members of the Hesperidae, commonly known as skippers, have also been reported in several studies such as Palei et al. (2014) ^[38], Nandana et al. (2019), Nagarjan et al. (2020), Hedge et al. (2020), Saha et al. (2023) ^[44], Jaiswal et al. (2023) ^[24], Narmadha et al. (2023) ^[37], Kokkadan et al. (2023), Rout et al. (2023) ^[42, 43], Thirupamreddy et al. (2023) ^[52], Das et al. (2024) ^[11], Santosh et al. (2025), Kumari et al. (2025) and Das et al. (2026) ^[10], reflecting their presence in a variety of terrestrial ecosystems.

In contrast, the family Riodinidae has been less frequently reported in the literature, with only a few studies such as Patra et al. (2022) ^[41], Das et al. (2025) ^[9, 12, 14, 15, 16], Kumari et al. (2025) and Das et al. (2026) ^[11] documenting their occurrence. The relatively lower number of records may be attributed to their limited distribution, specialized habitat requirements, or under-sampling in many regional surveys.

Overall, the synthesis of these studies demonstrates that butterfly diversity across regions is primarily dominated by Nymphalidae, Lycaenidae and Pieridae, while Papilionidae, Hesperidae and Riodinidae contribute comparatively fewer species. This pattern reflects ecological variability, habitat heterogeneity and differences in sampling intensity across studies,

emphasizing the need for continued monitoring and comprehensive biodiversity assessments. The compiled dataset documented a total of 429 butterfly species belonging to six families across four major biogeographical regions of India, namely the Deccan Peninsula, Western Ghats, East Coast, and West Coast. Among these families, Nymphalidae represented the most dominant group, followed by Lycaenidae, Hesperidae, Pieridae, Papilionidae, and Riodinidae. Most species exhibited a wide distribution pattern, with a large proportion categorized as ubiquitous, occurring across all four regions. Several species were also classified as common, indicating their presence in multiple regions but not throughout the entire study area. The Deccan Peninsula recorded the highest species occurrence, reflecting its extensive geographical coverage and habitat diversity. The Western Ghats, recognized as a global biodiversity hotspot, also supported a substantial number of species, including several regionally restricted taxa. In contrast, the East Coast and West Coast regions showed comparatively moderate species representation but still contributed significantly to the overall diversity. A smaller proportion of species were categorized as localized or rare, indicating restricted distribution within specific regions. These species were often associated with specialized habitats or limited geographical ranges. Overall, the results highlight significant regional variation in butterfly diversity and distribution, with widespread species dominating the assemblage while a smaller fraction exhibit localized occurrence. The compiled checklist provides a comprehensive overview of butterfly diversity across major ecological regions of India.

The order Lepidoptera comprised a total of 429 butterfly species distributed among six families. Among them, Nymphalidae was the most dominant family with 143 species, accounting for 33.33% of the total diversity (Figure 2). This was followed by Lycaenidae, which contributed 103 species (24.01%), and Hesperidae with 78 species (18.18%). The family Pieridae represented 60 species (13.99%), while Papilionidae comprised 39 species (9.09%). In contrast, Riodinidae was the least represented family with only 6 species (1.40%). Overall, the results indicate that Nymphalidae and Lycaenidae together constitute more than half of the recorded butterfly diversity, highlighting their dominance within the order Lepidoptera in the compiled dataset.

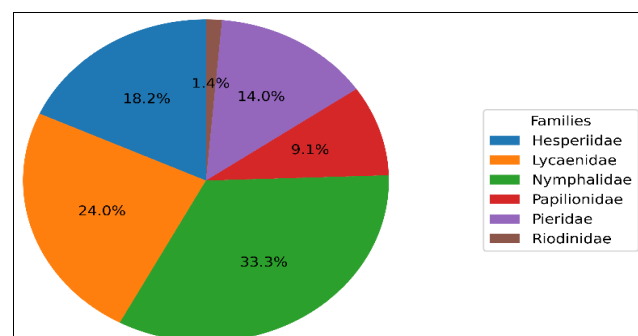


Fig 2: Percentage distribution of butterfly species among different families

The distribution of butterfly species across the four biogeographical zones showed noticeable variation (Figure 3). The Deccan Peninsula recorded the highest species richness with 397 species (30.08%), followed by the East Coast with 339 species (25.68%). The Western Ghats supported 303 species (22.96%), highlighting its importance as a major biodiversity hotspot. In contrast, the West Coast exhibited comparatively lower diversity with 284 species (21.53%). Overall, the results indicate that the Deccan Peninsula and East Coast together contribute more than half (55.76%) of the recorded butterfly diversity, demonstrating their substantial role in shaping the butterfly assemblage within the study area.

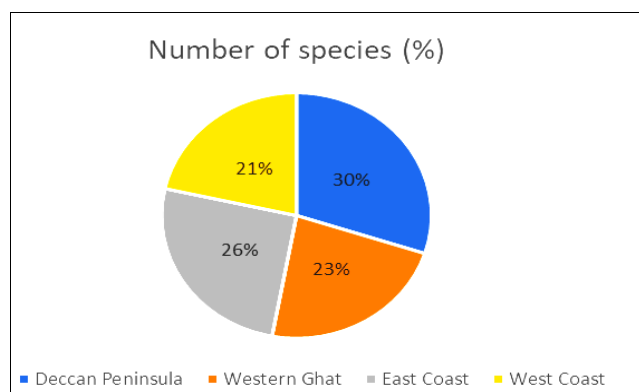


Fig 3: Percentage distribution of recorded butterfly species across four geographical regions

The relative abundance analysis of the recorded butterfly species revealed clear variation among distribution categories (Figure 4). Ubiquitous species dominated the assemblage with 221 species (51.52%), indicating that more than half of the recorded species are widely distributed across the study area. This was followed by localized species comprising 79 species (18.41%), suggesting the presence of several taxa restricted to specific habitats or regions. Common species accounted for 75 species (17.48%), while rare species represented the smallest proportion with 54 species (12.59%). The results indicate that the butterfly community is largely dominated by widely distributed species, whereas a smaller proportion of species exhibit restricted or rare occurrence patterns.

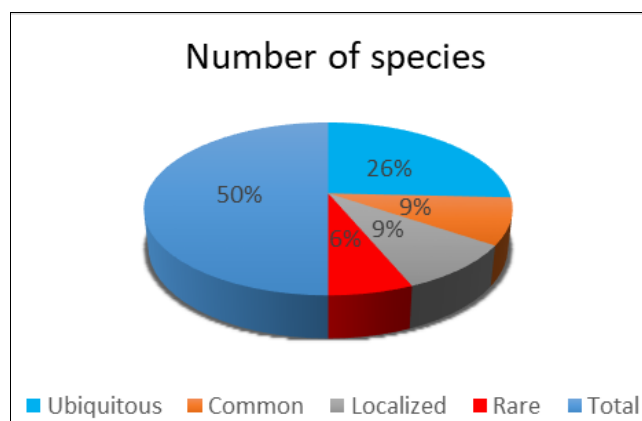


Fig 4: Percentage distribution of butterfly species according to relative abundance categories

Conclusion

The present review provides a comprehensive synthesis of butterfly diversity reported from four major geographical regions of India based on published studies from the last decade. A total of 429 species belonging to six families were documented, indicating considerable diversity across these regions. The family Nymphalidae was found to be the most dominant, followed by Lycaenidae, Hesperidae, Pieridae, Papilionidae and Riodinidae. A large proportion of species showed a wide distribution pattern and were categorized as ubiquitous, while several others were recorded as common across multiple regions. The variation in species composition among the regions reflects differences in habitat characteristics, vegetation types and ecological conditions. Overall, this review highlights the richness of butterfly diversity in these regions and emphasizes the importance of continued documentation and monitoring for better understanding and conservation of butterfly fauna.

Limitation of this review

A limitation of the present review is that it does not cover all geographical regions due to the limited availability of published literature from certain areas. The analysis is therefore restricted to regions with accessible studies, which may influence the completeness of the overall assessment of butterfly diversity patterns.

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